

וַיֹּאמֶר ה' אֵל: (10:21) חֹשֶׁךְ. The פסוק says: מכות. we read about the מכות, פרשת בא
פרעה. There's a pattern in the מכות, for some of them חֹשֶׁךְ על השמים ויהי חֹשֶׁךְ על ארץ מצרים וימש חֹשֶׁךְ
וַיֵּט מֹשֶׁה אֶת יָדוֹ עַל הַשָּׁמַיִם: (10:22) "חֹשֶׁךְ" משה, "Let there be חֹשֶׁךְ" but for חֹשֶׁךְ he did not. התראה
וַיְהִי חֹשֶׁךְ אֲפֹלָה בְּכָל אֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם שְׁלֹשֶׁת יָמִים. This darkness was unlike any other, it was so intense and thick that
The Egyptians were frozen in place for three days. However, but - לא ראו איש את אחיו ולא קמו איש ממתחתיו שְׁלֹשֶׁת יָמִים: (10:23)
אור. Not only that, we had כלל ישראל - but - וּלְכָל בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הָיָה אֹרֶךְ בְּמוֹשְׁבֵיהֶם, אור. However, we know from the מדרש that they were able to travel through all the houses
to take a look at all their goodies so when it came time to borrow all of the כלים, the מצריים said, "We don't have anything", and בני
ישראל were able to respond, "Actually, you do, it's in the closet, third drawer on the left." They knew exactly where it was because they were able to look around the מצריים's houses during חֹשֶׁךְ. So this was a
חֹשֶׁךְ that only affected the מצריים, but not בני ישראל.

The חידושי הרי"ם, the Gerrer Rebbe, offers a profound insight into the phrase **לֹא יָאוּ אִישׁ אֶת אָחָיו**. He teaches **החשך הגרוע ביותר - What is the greatest חשך that we experience in our lives in עולם הזה?**

לֹא רָאוּ אִישׁ אֶת אָחִיו - כְּאִשֶּׁר אֵינּוּ רוֹצֶה לִרְאוֹת אֶת אָחִיו בְּצַעְרוֹ וּלְהוֹשִׁיט לוֹ עֲזָרָה

This pasuk is a מוסר statement. What is the greatest חשך? חשך - if you don't see your friend when he's having difficulty, he's having his own צער, and as a result you don't extend him a helping hand, that is the greatest חשך. What's going to happen to someone who acts this way, ignoring his friend's plight? What will be the result? התוצאה היא, ש'כאשר אדם מתעלם ממצוקתו של חברו - When a person ignores and totally is uninterested in his friend's difficulty; אין הוא עצמו יכול למוש ממקומו - he himself, מידה כנגד מידה, will not be able to help himself. He'll have his own צרות, and he'll be stricken with exactly the same issues. He will have a problem, and nobody will help him, מתחתיו, ולא קמו איש מתחתיו. When we see anybody having difficulty, we should extend a hand, and help in whatever way we can.

The day that I'm recording this is the **שלושים** for my **תיירה ברידער**, and that's exactly who he was, a man who always ran to help people at all times.

